Articuwin

By Alex A, Tyler C, Arden G, Grace W

Overview:

Articuwin is a to-do list, progress tracking app for a variety of ages made to be intuitive and easy to use while still being entertaining for the users.

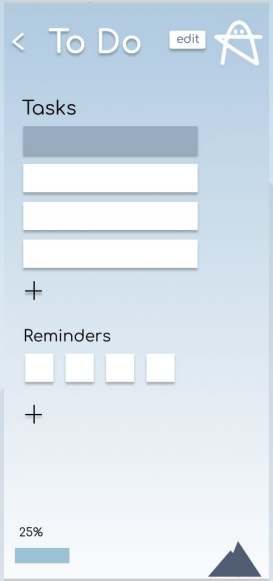
Key Features

- ★ *Easy to use (Intuitive design)*
- ★ *Customizable*
- ★ *Fun/ Entertaining*
- ★ *To do list feature*

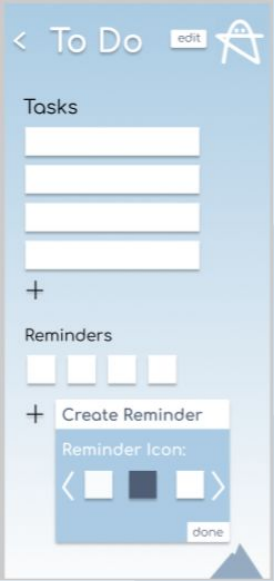
Quick Preview:

Home

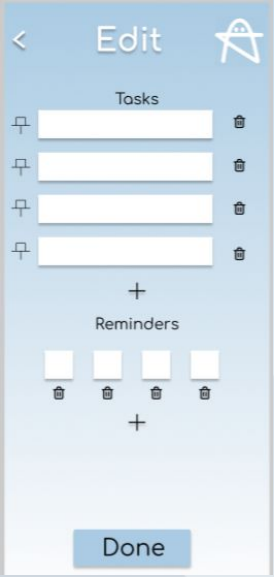
Tasks



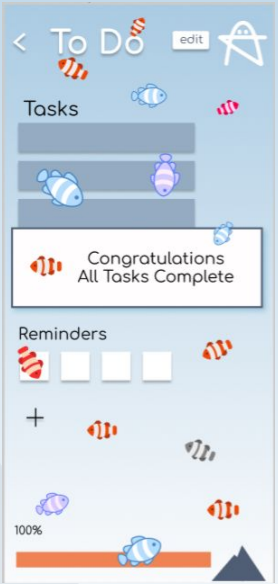
Reminder



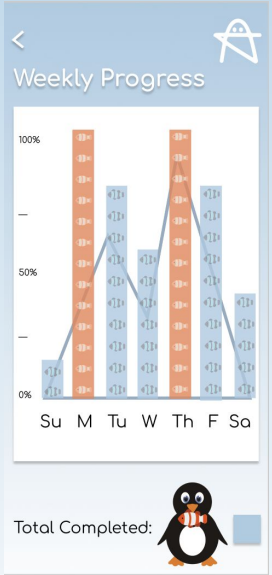
Edit



Completed



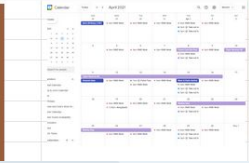
Progress

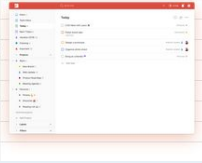


Competitive Analysis:

We learned that we have a unique idea that covers more than a basic calendar or to-do list as Google Calendar does. Our most unique feature is our to-do list app which is also a "game," unlike apps such as Todoist or Google Calendar- making our Articuwin more entertaining and enthralling for a younger audience.

	Articuwin	Google Calendar	Todoist	Forest
Customizable CheckList	✓	✓	✓	
Visual Display of Progress (chart)	✓			✓
Habit Tracker	✓			
Ease of Use	✓	✓	✓	✓
Interactive "game" aspect	✓			✓
Has mobile application	✓	✓	✓	✓
Calendar view		✓	✓	





Personas:

"Michael"

"Penelope"

"Jeremiah"

(Images generated on https://thispersondoesnotexist.com/)

Persona 1: *Michael*

- Michael "Mikey" Zukerman
- 13 y/o, male (he/him)
- Middle Schooler (8th grade)
- **Technology use**: iPhone, tablet, school Chromebook
- **Favorite Brands:** Nike, Old Navy, Target, Vans, Apple, Google

User goal: His parents were concerned with grades and inability to keep track of everything he needs to do. Mikey is struggling with his grades and wants an easy and entertaining way to keep track of everything he needs to do.

Frustrations & Pain points

- Normal apps are too boring
- Some apps (Google Calendar) are too dense and hard to understand
- He doesn't think time management is "cool" or entertaining, sees it as a chore

Based on Michael's frustration we considered making the app seem "cooler" and easier to understand. We implemented a game for him to interact with while completing his many tasks for school and other activities and responsibilities.

Also, we considered his complaints about normal apps being too boring, and thought it'd be a good idea to implement penguins into the game. Instead of only focusing on his tasks, he will get rewarded for his achievements and we believe it would get him to always use our app because he knows there is a reward for completion.

Persona 2: *Penelope*

- Penelope Xiu
- Bio: 20 y/o, Female (she/her)
- Junior in College, RA, Club President, Student Tutor
- **Technology use**: Android phone, Mac, Smart watch
- **Favorite Brands:** Walgreens, LuluLemon, Gap, Urban Outfitters

User goal: Penelope struggles to keep track of everything she needs to do.. Between her job, extracurriculars, and her tutoring position she has a lot of things to keep track of. Penelope is looking for a low-maintenance highly customizable app.

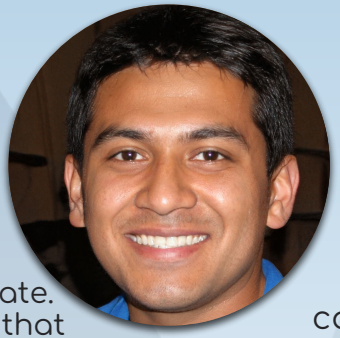
Frustrations & Pain points

- Apps have not been customizable
- Apps taking too long to use/set up and thus make it difficult to use on the go
- App won't provide option to carry over items over multiple days

Based on Penelope's busy lifestyle and her need for an app that can be glanced at while on the fly we designed Articuwin with a very simplistic and high-utility interface.

We needed Penelope to be able to adjust quickly and have minimal required upkeep. If accidentally tapped a task off she could just as easily unmark it and tap the correct one. If Penelope needed a task to reappear day after day without retyping it out she can just pin that particular task; the same with reminders. She could also customize those reminders by choosing photos from her library to use as the thumbnails for menial tasks.

Persona 3: *Jeremiah*



- Jeremiah Leman
- Bio: 25 y/o, male (he/him), College graduate, Employed full-time
- **Technology use**: Mac, Apple Watch, Ipad w/ Apple Pencil, iPhone
- **Favorite Brands:** Apple, Adidas,

User goal: Jeremiah is a fresh college graduate. He's just beginning his career in a company that designs home appliances. Currently overwhelmed with a new idea for an iToaster, Jeremiah is struggling to keep up with work responsibilities, as a new employee, and home obligations.

Frustrations & Pain points

- Struggling to find a good To-Do list for his everyday needs
- Hasn't used a To-Do list app before
- Finds some To-Do list apps overwhelming and hard to use

Jeremiah is new to any kind of To-Do list. While considering his frustrations, we thought to make the app more straightforward. The app needed to be more user friendly, so we did not include any unnecessary buttons or complex directions on the app. Everything was kept very simple and direct.

We designed it to give basic options, and those options can easily be toggled by simple clicks. We kept the interface intuitive, and have made sure that our app causes less frustration on the user and allows them to access their many different tasks and reminders easily.

Initial wireframes:

The initial structure of our wireframes was based more towards getting the desired functionalities placed rather than user ease at first. We laid Articuwin out in a similar fashion to other apps. Homepage, back buttons in the top left corners, edit buttons in the top right corners, etc.

Once basic functionality was complete, we went about designing Articuwin. Layout and the use of symbols was by far the most complicated. Some buttons we compromised with words. Others we found images that looked universally understandable. We had some struggles with spacing since bigger fingers need more padding, and with font size for those with vision problems. It's hard to function in ease of use when you can't always think of all the issues, which is why user testing was invaluable.

Applications from User Testing:

We got a lot of positive feedback! Some changes we implemented included:

- Updating the Home Page
  - Adding a mountain icon to the Weekly Progress button
  - Adding the Title "Articuwin" to the homepage
- Making universal "trash" symbols in the edit screen and changing the minus icons to trash can icons
- Separating the tasks and reminders further
- Adjusting font size for readability
- Adding drop shadow to buttons to distinguish them as clickable buttons

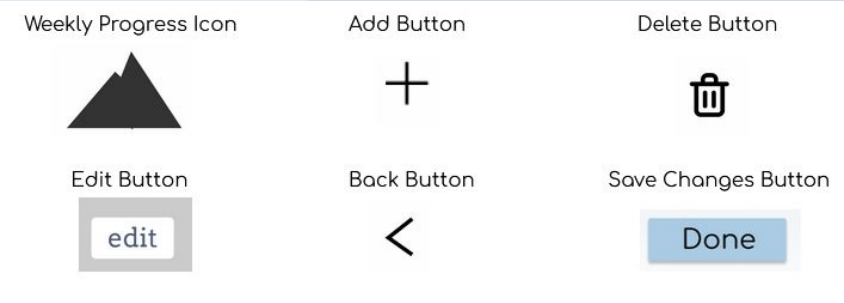
Visual design/development:

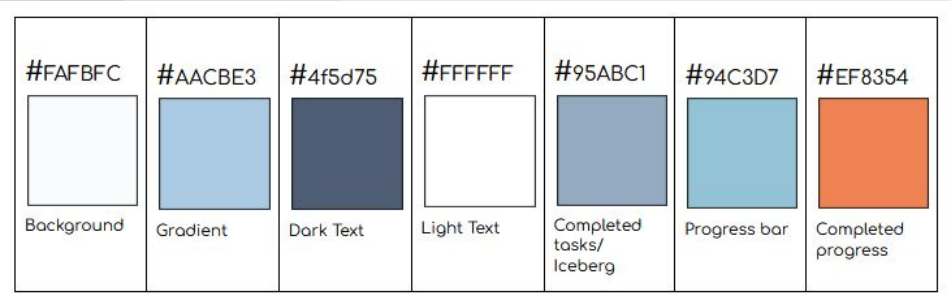
Designing the look of the app was a challenge. We wanted something that was visually engaging enough, that supported our fun theme of feeding the penguin fish, but was not too overwhelming.

We kept our color palette rather consistent as we knew we were going with an arctic theme going in, but we went through several iterations of how we would use these colors.

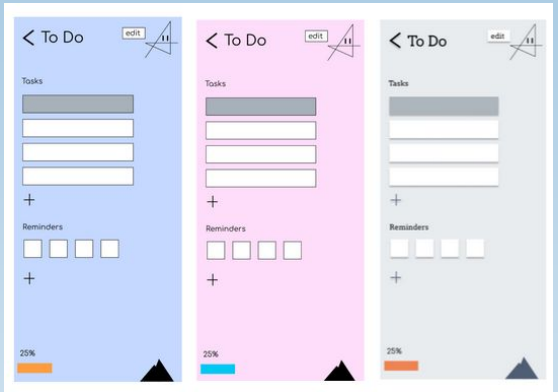
Our font choice was also something we kept rather consistent throughout the whole process. We felt that comfortaa worked well stylistically and fit accessibility guidelines for readability.

The icon also went through a few iterations, always the same idea, but changing the execution slightly to improve the look. We made it thicker and rounder for readability and to match the aesthetic of the app better.





Articuwin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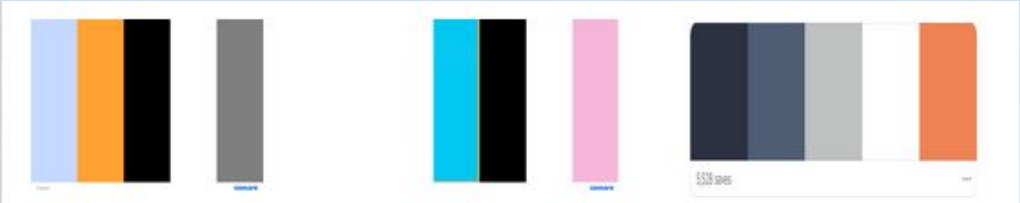

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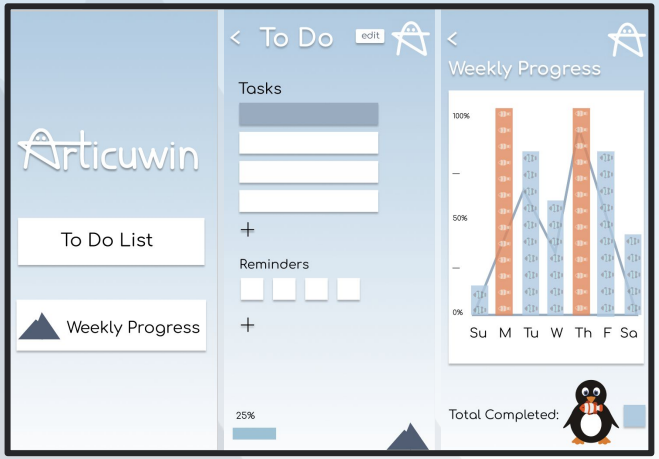
To Do
Tasks
Reminders

Retrospective:

We learned a lot about what makes the app visually appealing through trial and error and we learned the value of user testing in order to improve our app.

We ended up loving our final product and we believe we successfully created a visually appealing and user friendly experience.

We also became more familiar with figma as a program.

If we had more time, we may have added more customizability to the app (user being able to change icons, change colors, etc) and had more user scenarios.